

Monday, 13 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

27° 14°

MANCHESTER

Mostly clear

27° 15°

GLASGOW

Partly cloudy

21° 13°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1 **Police investigating the death of Ann Widdecombe say they don't believe there's a political motive, following a new arrest.**

A 28-year-old man was arrested in Rotherham, South Yorkshire, and police say they are not looking for anyone else. The former MP was found dead at her home in Devon on Thursday morning.

CRIME · UK

- 2 **A British couple have been rescued from a ravine in Spain after suffering severe burns in the wildfires raging through Almeria province.**

Local media reports say the unnamed pair were found semi-conscious with 40% burns after being trapped by the blazes. Hundreds of firefighters are battling the deadly wildfires.

DISASTER · INTERNATIONAL

- 3 **Parts of the UK are facing an 'exceptional' wildfire risk as heat health alerts are issued across the country.**

This comes as temperatures are set to remain above the heatwave threshold for a second consecutive week. Authorities are urging the public to be vigilant.

WEATHER · UK

- 4 **A record 128 people have crossed the English Channel in a single small boat, according to new figures.**

The vessel made the journey on Friday, when a total of 225 migrants arrived in the UK on three boats. This marks a significant increase in numbers.

MIGRATION · UK

- 5 **One of the UK's largest water companies has recorded its highest ever level of demand for water.**

Severn Trent reported demand reaching almost 2.4 billion litres in recent days, as the country experiences a prolonged heatwave. This puts pressure on water resources.

ENVIRONMENT · UK

What's coming up

1 **Reading Festival is applying to have music on its main stage for a fourth day, extending the popular event.**

Historically, Wednesdays and Thursdays have served as warm-up days before the main weekend performances. This move could mean even more live music for festival-goers.

ON AIR – Would you welcome an extra day of music at Reading Festival, or is the current length just right?

MUSIC · COMING UP

2 **Pitbull fans have set a new Guinness World Record for the largest gathering of people wearing bald caps!**

Mr Worldwide's dedicated followers achieved the feat, with 22,000 people donning bald caps in a tribute to the star. It sounds like quite a sight!

ON AIR – What's the most unusual or dedicated thing you've ever seen a fan do for their favourite artist?

MUSIC · NOW

3 **John Constable's iconic painting 'The Hay Wain' has arrived in Suffolk for the very first time in its history.**

Despite depicting a Suffolk scene, the famous artwork has never actually been displayed in the county until now. It's a homecoming that's been centuries in the making.

ON AIR – Which famous artwork would you love to see visit its real-life setting?

ART · NOW

4 **The historic Bayeux Tapestry has arrived in the UK for the first time in 900 years, under police guard.**

The 70-metre embroidery, which depicts the events leading up to the Norman Conquest, will go on display in September. It's an incredible piece of history making a rare journey.

ON AIR – Have you ever seen the Bayeux Tapestry? What's the most impressive historical artefact you've ever laid eyes on?

HISTORY · COMING UP

5 **BookTok is inspiring a new generation of readers, including those who previously avoided books, like one dyslexic woman who now runs a book club.**

Romance novels, in particular, are enjoying a huge boom, with dedicated bookshops even opening up. It just goes to show the power of online communities.

ON AIR – Has social media ever introduced you to a new hobby or passion you didn't expect to love?

BOOKS · NOW

On the schedule

1 **Brendon McCullum has been sacked as England's Test head coach, leaving the team without both a coach and captain.**

McCullum leaves after four years in the role, marking the end of the 'Bazball' era. It's a significant shake-up for English cricket.

ON AIR – What do you think the future holds for England's Test team after McCullum's departure?

CRICKET · UK

2 **England and Argentina are set to renew their historic World Cup rivalry in Wednesday's semi-final clash.**

From the 'Hand of God' to David Beckham's redemption, their encounters have been legendary. It promises to be another thrilling chapter in their footballing history.

ON AIR – What's your favourite memory or most talked-about moment from an England vs. Argentina match?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 **Sophie Ecclestone has made history by becoming the first English woman to be added to the Lord's honours board.**

She achieved the feat by taking five wickets during India's second innings in the one-off Test. It's a fantastic achievement for the spin bowler.

ON AIR – How important is it to celebrate these historic milestones in women's sport?

CRICKET · UK

4 **Jude Bellingham scored twice, including an extra-time winner, as England came from behind to beat Norway 2-1.**

The victory in Miami sees England reach the World Cup semi-finals, keeping their hopes alive. Bellingham's performance was truly outstanding.

ON AIR – After that thrilling win, how confident are you feeling about England's chances in the semi-finals?

FOOTBALL · UK

5 **Japan's Tokito Oda has retained his Wimbledon wheelchair men's singles title, defeating Great Britain's Alfie Hewett.**

Oda beat Hewett in straight sets, showcasing his dominance on the grass courts. It was a tough match for the British player.

ON AIR – What an incredible achievement for Tokito Oda! Do you follow the wheelchair tennis at Wimbledon?

TENNIS · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A surprising new study suggests that looking at pictures of 'cute animals' can actually improve your concentration.**
Researchers found that participants who viewed images of puppies and kittens before a task performed better and were more focused. It seems a quick dose of adorable can give your brain a helpful boost!
- 2 The simple act of 'watering houseplants' is being hailed as a new mindfulness trend.**
Many are finding peace and a moment of calm in the gentle ritual of caring for their indoor greenery. It's a small, quiet moment that can break up a busy day.
- 3 A charming movement encouraging 'swapping homegrown produce' with neighbours is gaining popularity.**
From surplus courgettes to a bounty of berries, people are sharing their garden gluts, fostering community spirit and reducing food waste. It's a lovely way to connect over fresh food.
- 4 The humble 'notebook' is making a big comeback, with many opting for pen and paper over digital notes.**
There's a growing appreciation for the tactile experience of writing things down, with advocates claiming it helps memory and creativity. Perhaps it's time to dig out that fancy pen!
- 5 A delightful trend for 'identifying different types of clouds' is encouraging people to look up more often.**
From fluffy cumulus to wispy cirrus, sky-gazers are discovering the beauty and variety in our skies, turning a simple glance upwards into a fascinating nature watch.
- 6 The gentle art of 'pressing flowers' is seeing a lovely resurgence as a creative and calming hobby.**
Collecting blooms from gardens and walks, then carefully preserving them, is proving to be a wonderfully mindful activity, perfect for creating unique keepsakes and decorations.
- 7 Interest in 'the history of local landmarks' is encouraging more people to explore their own towns.**
From old market crosses to ancient churches, uncovering the stories behind familiar places is revealing surprising tales and a deeper connection to local heritage.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'tidying up' what in a restaurant or café while waiting for our order?

ANSWER: THE SUGAR SACHETS AND CONDIMENT BOTTLES ON THE TABLE!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'song' they absolutely have to hum or sing to themselves when doing the washing up. What's their go-to tune?

ANSWER: WHATEVER'S CURRENTLY STUCK IN THEIR HEAD, OFTEN A CATCHY POP SONG!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes you discover a 'hidden gem' of a charity shop and it's full of absolute treasures?**
Have you ever found something truly amazing, perhaps a vintage item or a book you'd been searching for, in a charity shop? What was your best ever find?

- **We all have those 'little habits' that make our morning brew just perfect, don't we?**
Are you a 'milk first' or 'milk last' person for your tea? Do you have a specific mug or a particular way of stirring? What are your non-negotiable rules for a perfect cuppa?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that a group of owls is called a 'parliament'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The sound that a camel makes is officially called a 'gurgle'.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£7.6 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£7.6 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's smallest chameleon, the *Brookesia micra*, is so tiny it can sit on the head of a match.
- The British tradition of eating fish and chips became popular in the 1860s.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time, equal to one hundredth of a second.
- The highest mountain in the British Isles is Ben Nevis in Scotland, standing at 1,345 metres.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- The first ever postage stamp, the Penny Black, was issued in the UK in 1840.
- Strawberries are the only fruit with seeds on the outside.
- The iconic red telephone box was designed by Sir Giles Gilbert Scott for a competition in 1924.

On this day

Day 194 of the year, 171 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abd-al-Masih; Christian feast day: Abel of Tacla Haimonot (Coptic Church); Christian feast day: Clelia Barbieri; Christian feast day: Conrad Weiser (Episcopal Church (USA)). Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1963 — Neal Foulds, English snooker player and sportscaster
- 1979 — Craig Bellamy, Welsh footballer
- 1949 — Bryan Murray, Irish actor
- 1988 — Tulisa, English singer-songwriter and actress
- 1956 — Mark Mendoza, American bass player and songwriter
- 1992 — Rich the Kid, American rapper
- 1953 — Gil Birmingham, American actor
- 1957 — Cameron Crowe, American director, producer, and screenwriter

THE DAY TODAY

- 2020 — After a five-day search, the body of American actress and singer Naya Rivera is recovered from Lake Piru in California, where she had drowned.
- 1973 — Watergate scandal: Alexander Butterfield reveals the existence of a secret Oval Office taping system to investigators for the Senate Watergate Committee.
- 2008 — Battle of Wanat begins when Taliban and al-Qaeda guerrillas attack US Army and Afghan National Army troops in Afghanistan. The U.S. deaths were, at that time, the most in a single battle since the beginning of operations in 2001.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1977 — Amidst a period of financial and social turmoil, New York City experiences an electrical blackout lasting nearly 24 hours that leads to widespread fires and looting.
- 1977 — Somalia declares war on Ethiopia, starting the Ogaden War.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1973 — Watergate scandal: Alexander Butterfield reveals the existence of a secret Oval Office taping system to investigators for the Senate Watergate Committee.

- 2016 — Prime Minister of the United Kingdom David Cameron resigns, and is succeeded by Theresa May.
- 2011 — United Nations Security Council Resolution 1999 is adopted, which admits South Sudan to member status of United Nations.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 195 of the year, 170 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Blessed Angeline of Marsciano; Christian feast day: Gaspar de Bono; Christian feast day: Camillus of Lellis (Roman Catholic Church, except in the United States); Christian feast day: Deusdedit of Canterbury. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1966 — Matthew Fox, American actor
- 1938 — Tommy Vig, Hungarian vibraphone player, drummer, and composer
- 1930 — Polly Bergen, American actress and singer (died 2014)
- 1932 — Del Reeves, American country singer-songwriter (died 2007)
- 1926 — Harry Dean Stanton, American actor, musician, and singer (died 2017)
- 1987 — Dan Reynolds, American singer-songwriter
- 1923 — Dale Robertson, American actor (died 2013)
- 1918 — Arthur Laurents, American director, screenwriter, and playwright (died 2011)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1902 — Peruvian explorer and farmer Agustín Lizárraga discovers Machu Picchu, the "Lost City of the Incas".
- 2002 — French president Jacques Chirac escapes an assassination attempt from Maxime Brunerie during a Bastille Day parade at Champs-Élysées.
- 1950 — Korean War: beginning of the Battle of Taejon.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1911 — Harry Atwood, an exhibition pilot for the Wright brothers, is greeted by president William Howard Taft after he lands his aeroplane on the South Lawn of the White House, having flown from Boston.
- 1916 — Battle of Delville Wood begins as an action within the Battle of the Somme, lasting until 3 September 1916.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026	
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)